STARTUP ECOSYSTEM 3.0

Blockchain Infrastructure & Contribution Economy

Concept Document v0.5 · May 2026 · Augustin Jarak

This document captures the initial concept dump and structured framework for a blockchain-based contribution economy designed specifically for the global startup ecosystem. It is the first written record of this concept as developed in conversation in May 2026.

The concept addresses what may be the single most persistent unsolved problem in startup ecosystem development: nobody wants to finance it. Not governments reliably, not corporations sustainably, not individuals indefinitely. The blockchain contribution economy is designed to solve this from the inside out — by making ecosystem work financially legible, contribution-based, and self-sustaining.

Developed by Augustin Jarak · augustinjarak.com · Zagreb, Croatia

Part of the SE Foundation architecture. · Internal development use only.

1. The Core Problem Being Solved

Every existing startup ecosystem funding model shares a fundamental dependency: the money comes from outside the community — from governments, EU structural funds, corporate sponsors, or philanthropists. Every one of these sources has misaligned incentives. Governments fund what is politically visible. Corporations fund what serves their pipeline. Philanthropists fund what interests them personally. None of these reliably fund the unglamorous infrastructure work that ecosystems actually need.

The result, visible in Croatia and replicated across most of Europe and the developing world, is that the people doing the real work of ecosystem development do it for free, burn out, and eventually stop. The organizations they build collapse for lack of funds. The infrastructure they create deteriorates. And the ecosystem regresses.

The SE 3.0 blockchain framework addresses this not by finding a better outside funder, but by building a financial layer inside the ecosystem itself — one that rewards contribution, creates real utility, and generates sustainable funding for the infrastructure everyone depends on.

> *A foundational principle underlies this entire system: monetary reward is one of the best pieces of evidence of created value. When Ana converts three years of meetup organizing into real money, that transaction does not merely compensate her — it proves the ecosystem valued what she did. Acknowledgment without price is appreciation. Price without coercion is proof. The SE Token system is the market mechanism the ecosystem was previously missing — the one that would have prevented decades of burnout, organizational collapse, and talent leaving the field.*

2. The Token Mechanics

2.1 Proof of Contribution Token

The SE Token (working name) is a utility token earned by doing verified startup ecosystem work. It is not mined, not pre-allocated to investors, and not speculative by design. Its primary function is to represent and reward real ecosystem contribution.

Key properties:

— Earned through verified ecosystem activity — organizing events, mentoring, curating content, building community infrastructure, completing certifications, contributing data

— Distributed from a central pool managed by the SE Foundation

— Time-bounded — coins held by inactive accounts return to the pool after a defined inactivity period (demurrage mechanism)

— Permanent record — contribution history is written to the blockchain permanently, even after coins are returned

— Convertible — holders can convert to USDC/USDT stablecoin to extract monetary value before or at exit

2.2 The Demurrage Mechanic

The most distinctive feature of this token design is demurrage: the automatic return of coins to the central pool after a period of inactivity. This is not a penalty — it is a design feature that keeps the currency circulating where ecosystem work is actually happening.

Demurrage is an old economic concept (theorized by Silvio Gesell in the early 1900s) that blockchain makes practically implementable for the first time at scale. No existing SE token or community currency applies it in this specific way.

Contributor Type	Token Behavior
Active contributor	Earns tokens continuously. Tokens stay in wallet as long as activity continues.
Periodic contributor	Tokens remain valid during activity windows. Inactivity clock resets with each qualifying action.
Retired contributor	Chooses exit point. Converts remaining tokens to stablecoin. Coins return to pool. Record stays forever.
Honorary recipient	Recognized figures (Brad Feld, Steve Blank, etc.) receive recognition grants. If unclaimed after extended period, coins return to pool automatically.
Inactive account	After defined inactivity threshold, coins return to pool. Contribution record remains permanently.

2.3 Earning Mechanisms

Coins are earned through verified ecosystem actions. Verification is the critical design challenge — the system must reward genuine contribution without being gameable. Initial earning categories:

— Organizing a verified startup or tech community event

— Completing a mentoring session with a registered founder

— Curating and publishing verified ecosystem content

— Completing SEP, SG, or ScG certification programs

— Contributing verified data to SE.info or the ecosystem research database

— Serving as a community moderator or administrator for a registered SE organization

— Speaking at a verified startup ecosystem event

— Retroactive grants for documented historical contribution (proof required)

Weighting and coin amounts per action type are to be defined in the token economics document (v0.1 to follow). The principle: actions that build durable ecosystem infrastructure earn more than one-time actions.

2.4 The Exit Mechanism

When a contributor decides to stop their ecosystem work, they have a clean, fair exit path:

— Open the SE Wallet

— Initiate a conversion: SE Tokens → USDC/USDT at the current exchange rate

— The monetary value of their contribution is extracted

— The tokens themselves return to the central pool

— The contribution record remains on-chain permanently

This is the meetup organizer example: Ana organizes monthly startup meetups in Split for three years, earns tokens throughout, decides to stop, converts her tokens, and leaves the ecosystem with fair compensation for three years of real work. Her record remains. The coins return to fund the next Ana. The monetary value of her exit is not just compensation — it is market evidence that three years of community organizing had real, quantifiable value.

3. The Wallet Infrastructure

A standard crypto wallet (MetaMask, Trust Wallet) cannot enforce the demurrage mechanic or control the stablecoin conversion pathway. The SE Foundation must build and operate a specialized wallet.

The SE Wallet is a custodial or semi-custodial wallet that:

— Holds only SE Tokens and the designated stablecoin (USDC or USDT)

— Enforces the demurrage rules programmatically

— Provides the conversion interface for token-to-stablecoin exit

— Serves as the digital identity anchor for the SE ecosystem (see Section 5)

— Is accessible via mobile app and web interface

Starting with a custodial model is the pragmatic choice. It allows rule enforcement without the complexity of fully autonomous smart contracts, and is consistent with the Vested Steward architecture already designed for digital asset custody. The transition to a more decentralized model can happen as the system matures.

4. Individual & Organizational Registration Architecture

The system supports two distinct registration types: individual and organizational. The separation between them is not cosmetic — it is a foundational architectural decision that must be built in from day one rather than retrofitted later.

The cautionary reference is Facebook. Facebook built personal accounts first and bolted organizational pages on top of them, creating a permanent structural dependency: the page is tied to the person who created it. If that person leaves, loses access, or dies, the organization's digital presence is held hostage by an individual's personal account.

> *No individual account shall be a dependency for any organizational account. Organizations survive their founders, their administrators, and their contributors. The record belongs to the organization. The roles are temporary. The institution is permanent.*

4.1 Individual Registration

A private individual registers as themselves — a verified person with a permanent identity record. Key properties:

— Contribution history belongs to the individual, not to any organization they work through

— Portable across any organization they join, serve, or leave

— The SE Wallet and SE Digital ID are anchored to the individual account

— Leaving an organization does not affect the individual's token balance or contribution record

4.2 Organizational Registration

A private individual can register an organization — but the act of registration immediately separates the organization from the registrant's personal account. The registering person becomes the first administrator, not the permanent owner. From the moment of registration, the organization exists as an independent entity with its own token wallet, contribution record, digital identity, and role structure.

4.3 Role Architecture Inside Organizations

Role	Description
Founder / Registrant	The person who created the org record. Has no special permanent status beyond being first. All roles are transferable including this one.
Administrator	Manages the org account. Can add, remove, and reassign role-holders. At least one administrator must exist at all times.
Contributor	Earns tokens on behalf of the org or as an individual through org-verified activities, depending on the contribution split configuration.
Observer	Read access only. No contribution recording, no token earning.

4.4 Contribution Attribution Split

When ecosystem work is done through an organization, the system requires a deliberate design decision: who earns the tokens — the individual contributor or the organization? The answer is both, in a configurable split defined at organizational registration. Examples:

— 70% to the organization / 30% to the individual contributor

— 50% / 50% for organizations that want to maximize individual incentive

— 100% to the organization for purely institutional contributions

The split ratio is visible to all contributors before they join. This creates a market incentive for organizations to offer fair splits — organizations with poor splits will find it harder to attract contributors who can compare terms transparently.

5. The Buy-In Mechanism (Demand-Side Funding)

Not everyone enters the system by doing ecosystem work. Organizations, companies, and individuals who want to participate in or support the startup ecosystem can purchase SE Tokens with USDC directly. This serves multiple functions:

— Increases the monetary value of tokens already held by active contributors

— Creates a funding stream for the SE Foundation treasury without dependency on external grants

— Funds the digital skeleton infrastructure: the community portal, the true SE platform, national ecosystem projects, certification programs

— Gives buyers access to the same perks and services as earned-token holders (at appropriate tiers)

The buy-in mechanism is the bridge between the contribution economy and traditional fundraising. It is not speculative investment — it is payment for access and participation in a defined ecosystem with real utility.

6. Perks & Utility Layer

Token utility is what separates this from a speculative coin. Tokens (earned or purchased) unlock real value within the SE ecosystem:

Perk / Utility	Description
Research access	Access to paywalled startup ecosystem research, datasets, and reports. Replaces the current model where quality SE data is locked behind expensive institutional subscriptions.
SE ecosystem services	Access to services within the SE Foundation ecosystem — specific services to be defined as the platform builds out.
SE Digital ID	The SE Wallet functions as a verified digital identity usable across all SE Foundation platforms. One login, verified contribution history, portable reputation.
SE Academy courses	Discounted or free access to SEP, SG, and ScG certification programs based on token holdings.
SE.info premium content	Access to the full SE.info knowledge base including definitions, taxonomy, and ecosystem frameworks.
Startup Founders Club access	Token-gated access to the verified founders community.
SEB-Club access	Token-gated access to the Startup Ecosystem Builders/Developers community.
Scaleup Audit discount	Token holders receive discounted access to Scaleup Audit diagnostic services.
Governance participation	Staked tokens enable voting rights in SE Foundation governance decisions, including treasury allocation and platform development priorities.

7. Token as Legal Alternative to Money for Nonprofit Organizations

Nonprofit associations in most jurisdictions — including Croatian udruge, German Vereine, and equivalent EU nonprofit structures — face legal restrictions on receiving and using money for services. Direct monetary payments can trigger tax complications, threaten nonprofit status, or be prohibited under founding statutes.

The SE Token resolves this constraint structurally. Tokens that function as service credits within a defined ecosystem occupy a different legal category from money — closer to a voucher system or internal credit mechanism than to currency. This is not a loophole. It is a legitimate architectural solution to a structural problem that has handicapped nonprofit SE organizations for decades.

> *Where money creates legal barriers, the token creates legal pathways — because it is not money, it is ecosystem access.*

7.1 How Nonprofit Organizations Use Tokens

A nonprofit SE organization that cannot receive cash can still:

— Accumulate tokens through its verified ecosystem work — events organized, mentoring provided, community infrastructure built

— Spend those tokens across the entire SE service network — accessing courses, research, platform services, and tools

— Pay for SE Academy certification programs for its staff and volunteers

— Access SE.info, Scaleup Audit, Startup Founders Club, and SEB-Club services

— Participate in governance through staked tokens

7.2 The Token as Ecosystem Enabler

This section of the architecture reveals the token's deepest function: it is the connective tissue that makes the entire SE ecosystem of websites and services function as one integrated network. Every SE platform that accepts the token becomes part of the same economy: SE Academy, SE.info, Startup Founders Club, SEB-Club, Scaleup Audit, Scaleup Studio, SE Foundation research reports, Startup Events Online, and EUSE national chapter services. Token value is sustained not by speculation but by genuine service demand across a network of interconnected platforms.

7.3 Legal Architecture Note

The token must be explicitly documented as a utility token — a service credit within a defined ecosystem — not a security or an investment instrument. Jurisdiction-specific legal review is required per EU member state. The Swiss foundation model for the SE Foundation apex entity is again relevant here: Switzerland has relatively clear and permissive frameworks for utility tokens and service credit systems.

8. The Recognition Grant Program

A defined portion of the initial token supply is allocated to recognition grants for individuals and organizations that have made significant contributions to the global startup ecosystem before this system existed. Rationale: the ecosystem has benefited from decades of work by people who received no financial recognition for it. The SE Token system would lack moral legitimacy if it only rewarded future contributions while ignoring what was already built.

Honorary Recognition Tier

Global figures whose work shaped the startup ecosystem as we know it. Examples: Brad Feld, Steve Blank, Adeo Ressi, Brad Burnham, Fred Wilson, Paul Graham, and others to be defined by the founding governance council. Recognition grant issued, wallet created, notification sent. If accepted — welcome to the ecosystem. If unclaimed after an extended grace period — coins return to pool automatically.

Retroactive Contribution Tier

Ecosystem builders who did documented work before the system existed can apply for retroactive recognition grants. Proof is required (event records, organization founding dates, published content, LinkedIn history, community testimony). The retroactive program is the onboarding mechanism for the existing global community of ecosystem builders.

9. The Research Dimension

The research value of this system is arguably its most significant long-term contribution to the field — and it is generated as a byproduct of the system simply running. Every existing startup ecosystem dataset has a fundamental limitation: it measures organizations, funding rounds, and outputs. It almost never measures human contribution at the individual level over time.

The SE Token system generates a globally distributed, self-reporting, blockchain-verified contribution graph of the startup ecosystem. Every registered participant, every logged action, every earned or received token creates a data point. The aggregate is a living dataset of who is actually doing ecosystem work, where, for how long, and at what intensity. This dataset does not exist anywhere in the world right now.

The SE Foundation's research arm (SEI — Startup Ecosystem Institute) would have privileged access to this dataset. No other SE research organization — Startup Genome, Crunchbase, StartupBlink, Startup Heatmap — has or can have an equivalent. This is a structural monopoly on a new category of SE data, built as a side effect of a system designed for other purposes.

10. Standards & Definitions Layer

One of the most intractable problems in the startup ecosystem field is the lack of agreed-upon definitions. What is a startup? What is a scaleup? What counts as a startup ecosystem component? Top-down attempts to impose standards have consistently failed — they require everyone to agree, and nobody wants to cede definitional authority to someone else.

The SE Token system offers a different mechanism: adoption incentives rather than decree. If the SE Foundation's definitions are embedded in the platform and the platform achieves meaningful adoption, the definitions propagate through usage rather than authority. The definitions problem is solved not by agreement but by adoption.

11. Trust, Reputation & Bad Actor Identification

The contribution graph has a second major application beyond research: trust and reputation infrastructure for the ecosystem. Currently, the startup ecosystem has no reliable way to surface bad actors or verify trustworthiness. The SE Token system, because it records facts rather than opinions, creates the foundation for a trust layer:

— Startup founding and dissolution records — who was involved, for how long, when they left

— Cofounder relationship history — not who is to blame, but what happened and when

— Investment agreement transparency — term sheets and agreements that have been flagged by founders

— Organization track record — accelerators, incubators, and investors with verified history

The system must include due process by design. The accused must have the ability to respond, to provide their version of events, and to have that response attached permanently to the record. The goal is not punishment. It is transparency.

12. Idea Protection & Proof of Origin

A natural extension of the blockchain record is proof of origin for ideas and concepts. The SE Token system can provide a simple, low-friction mechanism: submit a hashed record of your idea or concept document to the blockchain at time of creation. The hash proves the document existed in that form at that time without revealing the content publicly.

This is not patent protection — it is proof of origin. Patent protection requires legal process and is expensive. Proof of origin requires only a timestamped record and is essentially free. For the SE Foundation specifically, this mechanism protects the conceptual frameworks, taxonomy documents, certification curricula, and research methodologies developed over years.

13. The DAO Layer

The SE Token system enables governance at multiple levels through DAO structures — Decentralized Autonomous Organizations where token holders vote on decisions proportional to their holdings and activity.

DAO Level	Function
City-level SE DAO	Local ecosystem governance. Token holders in a city vote on local treasury allocation, local event funding, local infrastructure priorities.
National SE DAO	Country-level governance. Coordinates national ecosystem strategy, allocates national chapter resources, interfaces with government and EU funding bodies.
Global SE DAO	Foundation-level governance. Major platform decisions, global treasury allocation, recognition grant approvals, standards ratification.

The DAO layer is not the starting point — it is where the system evolves after achieving sufficient scale and legitimacy. Starting with foundation-controlled governance and transitioning toward DAO governance as the community matures is the correct sequencing.

14. What This Funds

The SE Foundation treasury, funded through token purchases and a small transaction fee on all token conversions, provides the first sustainable, community-owned funding source for startup ecosystem infrastructure. Specific projects in the funding pipeline:

— The startup community web portal and forum

— The true SE platform — what Crunchbase, F6S, StartupBlink, and Startup Heatmap cannot be due to their own design limitations

— National startup ecosystem projects — including a restart of Startup Croatia and the Startup[Country] European namespace

— SE Academy curriculum development — SEP, SG, and ScG certification programs

— SE.info — the Wikipedia equivalent for the startup ecosystem world

— Startup Events Online — the comprehensive, community-owned events calendar

— jobs.startupecosystem.net — the dedicated job board for startup ecosystem careers

— EUSE — the EU Startup Ecosystem Organization, with employed national chapter moderators

— SE Foundation research operations — funding the SEI research arm and its data collection

14.1 jobs.startupecosystem.net — The Startup Ecosystem Career Platform

The startup ecosystem has produced thousands of job boards for people who want to work at startups. It has produced exactly zero dedicated job boards for people who want to work in the startup ecosystem itself — as ecosystem builders, community managers, accelerator program directors, national chapter coordinators, SE Academy instructors, ecosystem researchers, incubator managers, and the full range of professional roles that the SE infrastructure requires.

What it lists — startup ecosystem roles only:

— Startup Ecosystem Builder / Developer (SEB) roles

— Accelerator and incubator program management

— National and city-level ecosystem coordinator positions

— SE Academy instructors and curriculum developers

— Community managers for SE Foundation platforms

— Ecosystem research and data roles (SEI)

— SE Foundation operational and administrative roles

— EUSE national chapter staff positions

— Scaleup Audit and Scaleup Studio professional roles

— Startup community event and program managers

The job board connects directly to the SE Token contribution record: candidates can display their verified contribution history as part of their profile, replacing the unverifiable self-reported CV with an on-chain record of what they actually did, where, and for how long. Employers posting roles can specify SE Token contribution thresholds as qualification criteria.

No equivalent exists. LinkedIn lists ecosystem roles among millions of other roles with no specialization and no contribution record integration. jobs.startupecosystem.net is the first and only dedicated career platform for the startup ecosystem as a profession.

15. Market Positioning — Red Ocean or Blue?

This concept operates in more red ocean than blue. The individual components have existing players: Gitcoin does quadratic funding, Coordinape does contribution-based token distribution, Lens Protocol does on-chain reputation, BrightID does decentralized identity. None of these are doing what is described here.

The blue ocean is the integration and the specific domain. Nobody has assembled these mechanics specifically for the startup ecosystem as a unified, purpose-built system owned by the ecosystem, for the ecosystem. This is not launched as a crypto project competing for Web3 attention. It is launched as startup ecosystem infrastructure that uses blockchain as its backbone. Infrastructure first. Token second.

16. The Sequencing Problem — What Must Come First

The most common failure mode for community tokens and ecosystem coins is launching the token before the utility exists. The correct sequence:

Phase	Action & Rationale
Phase 1 — Utility first	Build the SE Wallet, the contribution tracking system, and the first perk layer (SE Digital ID, research access). The token has real use before it has real value.
Phase 2 — Community second	Onboard the first ecosystem builders through the retroactive recognition program. Earn trust before asking for participation.
Phase 3 — Liquidity third	Open the buy-in mechanism. At this point, the token has demonstrated utility and community. Demand is organic, not manufactured.
Phase 4 — DAO governance	Transition from foundation-controlled to community-controlled governance as token distribution reaches meaningful geographic and demographic breadth.

17. Governance Architecture: Era 1 Manual Selection & Era 2 Token Governance

One of the defining structural failures of SE 2.0 is self-electability. When there is no objective measure of contribution, whoever claims leadership loudest and longest tends to hold it. SE 3.0 solves this structurally, through the contribution record and token-weighted governance — but only after it starts running and accumulates sufficient data.

17.1 Era 1 — Manual Selection (Founding Generation)

The first presidents, board members, and legally required role-holders are chosen through a defined, transparent, human process. The selection criteria must be written down before any selection occurs. Key criteria:

— Verified, documented contribution history in the startup ecosystem — the primary criterion

— Self-nomination alone is insufficient — endorsement by at least two independent ecosystem actors required

— Longevity in the ecosystem is not the same as contribution to it — years in the field do not substitute for verified output

— Title-holding at other SE organizations is not a qualification — it may in fact be a disqualifying conflict of interest

— No individual may hold more than one founding role across SE Foundation entities simultaneously

Era 1 roles carry hard term limits — one or two terms maximum, non-renewable without a supermajority vote. Every role includes an explicit handover protocol. The founding generation's job is to build the system and hand it to the community.

17.2 The Era 1 Selection Process — Excluding SE 2.0 Failure Modes

Failure Mode	Design Response
Self-electability	No individual may nominate themselves without independent endorsement. Nomination requires documented contribution evidence, not a personal statement.
Network capture	Selection panel must include individuals from at least three different national ecosystems. No single ecosystem or organization may hold majority representation.
Title laundering	Holding a president or director title at another SE organization does not qualify someone — it triggers a conflict of interest review.
Permanence creep	All Era 1 roles have a defined end date written into the founding documents. No mechanism to extend without supermajority vote and public justification.
Knowledge hoarding	Institutional knowledge — contacts, relationships, processes, platform access — is documented and held by the organization, not by the individual.

17.3 Era 2 — Token Governance (Earned Governance)

Once the system has accumulated sufficient contribution data, governance transitions to token-weighted selection. Those who have done the most verified ecosystem work have the most say in who leads. Self-electability becomes structurally impossible. The transition from Era 1 to Era 2 requires a defined measurable trigger: minimum registered contributors, geographic distribution, volume of verified contribution records, and organizational registrations across multiple national ecosystems.

17.4 The Parasite/Symbiont Test

A practical heuristic for both eras: every governance role-holder should be evaluable against a simple question — is this person a net contributor to the ecosystem, or a net extractor? A symbiont creates value for the ecosystem while also benefiting from it. A parasite benefits from the ecosystem while creating little or no value. In SE 3.0, the contribution record makes this distinction visible. The parasite/symbiont test is not a moral judgment — it is a system health metric.

18. The Startup Ecosystem AI — Trusted Intelligence Layer

The Startup Ecosystem AI is not a general-purpose assistant. It is a purpose-built intelligence layer that sits on top of the entire SE 3.0 stack — the contribution record, the idea proof of origin registry, the trust and reputation system, and the organizational database — and answers questions that no search engine can answer because the underlying data does not exist publicly anywhere else.

The key design word is trustworthy. The AI does not generate opinions. It surfaces verified records at the permission level those records allow.

18.1 The Problems It Solves

The Duplicate Effort Problem

Two founders in different countries, working in different languages, building the same concept independently. Neither can find the other. In SE 3.0, both founders registered their idea hash at the time of conception. When founder A asks whether anyone else is working in this space, the AI can answer: yes, you are not alone — without revealing who, without revealing what. A binary signal. Enough to change the decision.

The Language Barrier Problem

A founder in Zagreb and a founder in Tallinn are building the same concept — one documented in Croatian, one in Estonian. The SE AI operates across all languages. Conceptual overlap is detected at the hash and semantic level, not the keyword level. The language barrier that currently allows parallel efforts to remain invisible to each other is removed.

The Trust Verification Problem

Is this person who they claim to be? Has this accelerator delivered what it promises? The SE AI draws on the trust and reputation layer to answer these questions at the permission level the records allow — not from rumor, not from anonymous accusation. The asker gets a useful signal. The subject's full record, including their response to any flags raised against them, is what the AI draws from.

The Sensitive Question Problem

Some questions in the ecosystem are currently unanswerable in public because asking them publicly is damaging. The SE AI provides a private channel for sensitive queries — a trusted intermediary that can answer carefully, at the right permission level, without exposing either the asker or the subject to unnecessary risk.

18.2 The Privacy Architecture

Record Type	AI Response Depth
Public record	The AI answers freely. Verified contribution history, public organizational records, published ecosystem data, accepted recognition grants.
Semi-public record	The AI confirms existence without revealing detail. Yes, someone is working in this space. Yes, this organization has a verified record. No further information.
Private record	The AI confirms binary signals only. Yes or no. Nothing more. The person who set the record to private controls what the AI can say about it.
No record	The AI says nothing meaningful. Silence is not confirmation of absence — it means nothing is registered. The AI does not speculate beyond the record.

18.3 The Multilingual Dimension

The SE AI operates in any language. The underlying records are language-agnostic — indexed by hash, by category, by geography, and by contribution type rather than by the language in which they were documented. This removes the single largest barrier to cross-border ecosystem connection that currently exists.

18.4 The Query Data Layer

Every query submitted to the SE AI is itself a data point — anonymized, but real. This query data, in aggregate, is another dimension of the contribution graph — the ecosystem's collective curiosity and concern made visible. It tells the SE Foundation what the community needs that it is not yet getting, where trust problems are concentrated, and where parallel efforts are accumulating without awareness of each other.

18.5 Position in the SE 3.0 Architecture

The SE AI is not a separate product. It is the primary interface layer through which most people will interact with the SE 3.0 system without needing to understand that any of those things exist underneath. A founder in Nairobi who does not know what a DAO is and does not care can ask the SE AI whether anyone else is building what she is building, and whether the investor who approached her last week is trustworthy. She gets useful answers. The underlying architecture that makes those answers reliable is invisible to her. That invisibility is a feature, not a limitation.

19. Open Questions & Next Steps

This is a v0.5 concept document. The following questions require dedicated development sessions:

— Token name and ticker symbol — to be determined pending domain and trademark availability checks

— Token economics — total supply, earning rates by action type, demurrage threshold and timeline, conversion rate mechanism

— Blockchain selection — Ethereum (ERC-20) vs. a Layer 2 solution (Polygon, Arbitrum, Base) for lower transaction costs

— Smart contract architecture — demurrage enforcement on-chain vs. custodial wallet enforcement

— Verification mechanisms — how contribution actions are verified without being gameable

— Legal structure — token issuance jurisdiction, securities law compliance across EU and US, Swiss foundation model applicability

— Nonprofit token use — jurisdiction-by-jurisdiction legal review of utility token vs. money distinction across EU member states

— Contribution attribution split defaults — recommended individual/org ratios by organization type

— Governance council composition — who sits on the founding council that ratifies the first standards and recognition grants

— Integration with existing SE platforms — how the SE Digital ID interfaces with Startup Grind, Founder Institute, and other global SE organizations

---

SE 3.0 Blockchain Infrastructure & Contribution Economy · Concept Document v0.5 · May 2026
Developed by Augustin Jarak · augustinjarak.com · Zagreb, Croatia